Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Friday, 23 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Rain	Rain	Light rain	Rain
14° 9°	11° 7°	12° 8°	8° 5°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **Barclays is reportedly planning to cut around 5,000 jobs as it looks to increase its reliance on artificial intelligence.**

The banking giant confirmed it is reducing its global workforce by about 5%, with many roles being replaced by AI technology. This move is part of a wider strategy to streamline operations and cut costs.

BUSINESS · UK

2 **A new report warns that the UK's Arctic defence capabilities have significant gaps, leaving it vulnerable to potential Russian attacks.**

MPs are urging the government to address these deficiencies, highlighting a shortage of Royal Navy warships and submarines in the region. Russia is increasingly asserting its dominance in the Arctic, making this a pressing concern.

DEFENCE · UK

3 **Scientists are launching a new study to test existing diabetes and ADHD drugs on Alzheimer's patients, hoping to accelerate treatment discovery.**

By testing multiple drugs simultaneously, researchers aim to quickly identify effective new treatments for this widespread form of dementia. This innovative approach could offer new hope for those affected by the condition.

HEALTH · UK

4 **New powers allowing judges to impose tougher punishments on criminals who refuse to attend their sentencing have been backed by victims' families.**

The aunt of Zara Aleena, who was murdered, said these changes would 'rebalance the power' towards victims. It's hoped this will prevent offenders from avoiding accountability in court.

JUSTICE · UK

5 **Good news for holidaymakers! Airbnb is introducing new rules meaning hosts can no longer ask guests to strip beds or wash dishes.**

The updated policy will apply to all reservations booked from November 20th onwards. This change aims to simplify check-out procedures and improve the guest experience.

TRAVEL · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Four locations are currently in the running to be crowned UK City of Culture 2029, with the winner set to receive a huge boost.**

The successful city, to be announced in early 2027, will get £10 million to fund a year-long programme of cultural events. It's a fantastic opportunity for an area to showcase its vibrant arts scene.

ON AIR — Which city do you think deserves to be the next UK City of Culture?

CULTURE · 2029

2 **Hit musical comedy-drama Glee is set for an exciting reboot, returning to screens after a decade away.**

The popular show, known for its catchy musical numbers and high school drama, will be back on Hulu and Disney+. Fans will be thrilled to see new life breathed into the series.

ON AIR — Are you excited for the return of Glee? What songs would you like to hear them perform?

TV · COMING SOON

3 **Author Helen Fielding, the creator of Bridget Jones, has launched a new award to find the next big diary-writing talent.**

The Bridget Jones Prize will celebrate the funniest 1,000-word diary-style piece of writing. It's a brilliant chance for aspiring writers to follow in Bridget's footsteps!

ON AIR — Could you write a funny diary entry? What would your Bridget Jones-style dilemmas be?

BOOKS · NEW

4 **Sacha Baron Cohen is bringing back his iconic character Ali G, more than two decades after the release of 'Ali G Indahouse'.**

The controversial but often hilarious character is making a return. Fans will be eager to see what new antics Ali G gets up to in today's world.

ON AIR — Are you ready for Ali G's comeback? Do you think the character will still resonate with audiences today?

COMEDY · RETURN

5 **If you're still planning your Halloween costume, some popular outfits are already emerging for this year's spooky celebrations.**

Expect to see lots of 'Freaky Nikki', Dolly Parton, and whimsical gargoyle costumes. It's always fun to see what trends take off for Halloween!

ON AIR — What's your go-to Halloween costume? Or are you more of a trick-or-treater?

SEASONAL · NOW

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **England's Harry Brook scored a sensational double century, but it wasn't enough to prevent a stunning defeat by Sri Lanka in a one-day international.**

Brook's incredible 202 was the first double century by an England batter in a one-day international. However, Sri Lanka pulled off a remarkable chase of 430 in Rawalpindi, leaving England fans stunned.

ON AIR — What an innings from Harry Brook! But that chase from Sri Lanka was truly something else, wasn't it?

CRICKET · UK

2 **Manchester United suffered a heavy 4-1 Champions League defeat to Como, piling pressure on head coach Michael Carrick.**

This was only Como's third-ever Champions League game, making the result even more chastening for United. Nico Paz starred for the Italian side, leaving many questions for United to answer.

ON AIR — Another tough night for Manchester United. What do you think needs to change at Old Trafford?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Declan Rice scored a late equaliser to earn Arsenal a draw against Bayern Munich in an entertaining Champions League clash.**

The Gunners battled hard, but the result was tinged with concern as Bukayo Saka limped off with an early injury. Fans will be hoping it's nothing too serious for the England star.

ON AIR — A good point for Arsenal, but how concerning is that injury to Saka for their season ahead?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Aston Villa are maintaining their perfect start in the Champions League, securing their third win from three against Norwegian side Viking.**

Their dominant display takes them up to second in the league phase, showing their strength in the competition. Villa fans will be delighted with their European form.

ON AIR — Aston Villa are flying in Europe! Can they go all the way in the Champions League this season?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Phil Foden produced a virtuoso display, scoring a sublime hat-trick as Manchester City beat AEK Athens in the Champions League.**

Foden's incredible performance helped City return to winning ways in the group phase, easing past the Greek side. It was a fantastic night for the England international.

ON AIR — Phil Foden was on fire last night! Is he one of the best players in the world right now?

FOOTBALL · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **The delightful practice of 'waving back' to a passing train driver is making a happy comeback across the UK.**

Many commuters and railway enthusiasts are reporting a noticeable increase in drivers returning friendly waves, adding a small moment of joy to their journeys. It seems a simple gesture can go a long way!

2 **A new study reveals that many of us are secretly quite proud of our unique methods for folding fitted sheets.**

Researchers found that rather than frustration, a sense of accomplishment often accompanies successfully taming the notoriously awkward linen. Share your top tips, we say!

3 **Experts are noticing a trend in people creating 'miniature indoor gardens' on windowsills, even in the smallest flats.**

These tiny green havens, often featuring succulents or small herbs, are providing a welcome touch of nature and a calming hobby for urban dwellers. Every little sprout helps!

4 **The comforting ritual of 'listening to the kettle boil' is being recognised as a small, mindful pause in our busy days.**

For many, the gentle rumble and eventual whistle offer a brief, involuntary moment of quiet reflection before the important business of tea-making begins. A true British micro-meditation!

5 **It turns out that the simple act of 'straightening a wonky picture frame' is a micro-moment of domestic contentment for many.**

That quick adjustment, bringing order to a slightly skewed world, delivers a surprising little burst of satisfaction. Who knew such a small thing could feel so good?

6 **The satisfying 'thunk' of a well-poured pint of milk landing perfectly in the fridge door is gaining recognition as a domestic delight.**

It's a subtle but deeply gratifying sound and sensation, signifying a successful restock and a perfectly organised fridge. A small victory in the kitchen!

7 **Research suggests that the 'satisfying click' of a well-secured food container lid brings a surprising sense of accomplishment.**

That audible seal is more than just practical; it's a small confirmation of a job well done, especially when packing up leftovers. Airtight and utterly delightful!

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of jam will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?**

ANSWER: SMELLING IT DIRECTLY FROM THE JAR — WITH A LITTLE HOPEFUL SNIFF!

Q **Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new bar of soap, especially if it's a particularly fragrant one. What is it?**

ANSWER: GIVING IT A GOOD, LONG SNIFF TO 'PRIME' IT BEFORE ITS FIRST USE.

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have that 'one particular corner' of our home that just feels utterly perfect, don't we?**
  Whether it's a cosy armchair by the window, a kitchen nook bathed in morning light, or even just a perfectly organised shelf, where is your favourite spot, and what makes it so special?

- **You know how sometimes a specific 'everyday object' just has a real story behind it, or it just means something special to you?**
  Perhaps it's a chipped mug from a memorable holiday, a well-worn gardening glove, or a book with a special inscription. What's one everyday item in your life that holds a surprising amount of sentimentality?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of owls is called a 'parliament'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** It's been suggested that a group of hummingbirds is called a 'glimmer'.

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The 'richest' soil on Earth is called 'chernozem', found in regions like Ukraine and Russia, and is incredibly fertile.
- Oxford University is older than the Aztec Empire.
- The shortest war in history lasted only 38 to 45 minutes, fought between Britain and Zanzibar in 1896.
- The 'king' of playing cards is the only one without a moustache.
- A pineapple is not a single fruit, but rather a collection of many individual berries fused together.
- The world's oldest known living tree, 'Methuselah', is a Great Basin bristlecone pine over 4,800 years old.
- The colour orange was named after the fruit, not the other way around.
- The Eiffel Tower can be 15 cm taller during the summer due to thermal expansion of the iron.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES FRI 23 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 296 of the year, 69 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Feast of the Most Holy Redeemer; Christian feast day: James the Just (i.e. James, brother of Jesus) (Lutheran, Episcopal Church (USA), Eastern Orthodox); Christian feast day: Æthelflæd of Romsey; Christian feast day: Allucio of Campugliano. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1948 — Gerry Robinson, Irish-born British businessman, arts patron and television personality (died 2021)
- 1976 — Ryan Reynolds, Canadian-American actor and producer
- 1985 — Chris Neal, English footballer
- 1976 — Cat Deeley, English model, actress, and television host
- 1969 — Brooke Theiss, American actress
- 1972 — Jimmy Wayne, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1985 — Miguel, American singer-songwriter and producer
- 1986 — Emilia Clarke, English actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 2022 — Myanmar Air Force airstrikes a concert in Hpakant Township, Kachin state killing at least 80 people, including senior Kachin Independence Organisation officials, in the Hpakant massacre.
- 2011 — The Libyan National Transitional Council deems the Libyan Civil War over.
- 2017 — War against the Islamic State: Philippine defense secretary Delfin Lorenzana declares the end of the Siege of Marawi.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1995 — Yolanda Saldívar is found guilty of first-degree murder in the shooting death of popular Latin singer Selena.
- 1991 — Signing of the Paris Peace Accords which ends the Cambodian–Vietnamese War.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2001 — Apple Computer releases the iPod.
- 1965 — Vietnam War: The 1st Cavalry Division (Airmobile), in conjunction with the Army of the Republic of Vietnam, launches an operation seeking to destroy Communist forces during the siege of Plei Me.

- 1989 — The Hungarian Republic officially replaces the communist Hungarian People's Republic.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES SAT 24 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 297 of the year, 68 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Anthony Mary Claret; Christian feast day: Arethas of Najran; Christian feast day: Eberigisil (Evergitus); Christian feast day: Blessed Giuseppe Baldo. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1994 — Krystal Jung, American-South Korean singer, dancer, and actress
- 1942 — Frank Delaney, Irish journalist and author (died 2017)
- 1966 — Zahn McClarnon, American actor
- 1957 — John Kassir, American actor and voice actor
- 1998 — Daya, American singer
- 1995 — Ashton Sanders, American actor
- 1983 — Adrienne Bailon, American singer-songwriter, dancer, and actress
- 1980 — Monica, American singer-songwriter, producer, and actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1998 — Deep Space 1 is launched to explore the asteroid belt and test new spacecraft technologies.
- 2014 — The China National Space Administration launches an experimental lunar mission, Chang'e 5-T1, which will loop behind the Moon and return to Earth.
- 2003 — Concorde makes its last commercial flight.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1949 — The cornerstone of the United Nations Headquarters is laid.
- 1950 — Annexation of Tibet by the People's Republic of China: The People's Liberation Army ceases all military operations in Tibet, ending the Battle of Chamdo.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 · PREVIEW

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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